

1 The contract

```
<page>/latex/  
  <stem>.tex      md2tex's section . header says "do not hand-edit"  
  <stem>.pdf      the compiled look . what the tab frames  
flat page fallback: <board>/latex/<stem>.* . the same fork deck.py takes
```

A hand-edited file is overwritten on the next build, which is the derived-plugin rule and not a defect. `--paper-root` is discovered by walking up from the page toward `--root` for a `0-*.bib`; a page outside any paper compiles cite-less with `\citep` printed as `[key]` rather than refusing. Inside a paper the master gains `natbib`, `plainnat`, and a `bibtex` pass against the paper's own bib.

2 What the writer inherits, and what it drops

```
### 1 . title      --> \section          the Content divisions map cleanly  
#### block        --> paragraph break  
\citep{} \ref{}    --> kept verbatim    already LaTeX  
> lanes           --> DROPPED          in Word they become comments;  
                                                           here they have nowhere to go  
refuse-to-regress --> inherited         a rewrite that loses citations  
                                                           is refused, not silently written
```

The proof run is QP4b's Content: eight divisions became a real four-page PDF, driven in a browser through the tab on 260815. What does not survive is the board's emoji-heavy ascii figures: xelatex drops glyphs its fonts lack, so a figure-dense page reads thinner in PDF than on stage, and A2 below is where that gap is measured rather than guessed.

3 The surface

```
82-plugin-exports.js --POST--> /_board/latex --runs--> md2tex + xelatex  
tab.url() names latex/<stem>.pdf . HEAD hit > frame it  
tab.write() builds on miss . lit-click      > REBUILD (derived refresh)  
failure   > a view page: the .tex + the log tail . never a blank frame
```